Fikile Mkhize 0210210785080

21 August 2026

HANDLE A RANGE OF CUSTOMER COMPLAINTS

US 252210

FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT

QUESTION 1

a) 1.Product-specific :Customers receive products or services that do not operate correctly

2. Wait times: long wait times are frustrating to many customers whether in agents phone or store, lengthy queue times will generate customer complaints because tike is precious to customers

3. Misunderstanding: miscommunication by the customer, company or both can trigger complaints

4. Delivery error: with online shopping on the rise, delivery Errors increase.

5. Personnel: Customers may feel slighted by employees who are Rude or uncaring

b) - Helps to categorize complaint correctly (is it product, staff, or system?)

- Helps to route complaint to the right department/person to solve it faster.

- Helps to understand root cause and prevent same complaint in future.

- Helps to prioritize urgent complaints e.g. safety vs minor inconvenience.

Question 2

a) - Ensures professionalism and consistency - trained staff handle complaints better.

- Provides a single point of contact so customer knows where to complain.

- Reduces burden on other staff so they can focus on their core jobs.

- Builds customer trust because organization shows it takes complaints seriously.

b) 1.boComplaint Register/Book: Physical book at reception where details are written.

2. Electronic CRM System: software like Pastel, Salesforce where complaints are logged.

3. Complaint Forms: Standard paper or online forms customers fill in.

4. Email/Log Sheets: email to complaints@company.com and logged in Excel.

5. Call Centre System: calls recorded and logged with reference number.

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Question 3

a) 1. Front-line staff / Receptionist / Cashier

2. Customer Care Manager / Complaints Handling Officer

3. Departmental Supervisors / Managers

4. Top Management / Business Owner

5. All employees in general (everyone is responsible)

b)- training: provide customer care, communication and conflict resolution training.

- Empowerment: give them authority to make decisions e.g. offer discount, replacement.

- Resources: Provide system, forms, telephone, computer, policy manual.

- emotional Support: counselling, debriefing sessions because dealing with angry customers is stressful.

- recognition/Reward: praise and incentives for handling complaints well.

*Question 4

a) - Reduces customer anxiety and frustration - they know what is happening.

- Builds trust and transparency - shows organization is honest.

- Prevents follow-up calls/complaints - customer won't keep calling.

- Meets legal requirement of keeping customer informed (Consumer Protection Act).

b) - Ensures systematic approach - no steps are missed.

- Helps allocate time, staff and resources efficiently.

- Helps set realistic timeframes for resolution.

- Reduces panic and allows for backup plan if first solution fails.

- Helps in prioritizing complaints.

Question 5

a) - Shows customer you care and you have not forgotten them.

- Keeps customer updated on progress so they remain patient.

- Allows you to get more information from customer to find right solution.

- Prevents customer from going to competitors or social media to complain.

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- Maintains good relationship and chance to retain customer.

a)1. Contact customer BEFORE deadline expires and explain reason for delay.

2. Apologize sincerely for delay.

3. Negotiate and agree on a new extended timeframe.

4. Escalate complaint to senior manager if needed.

5. Keep customer informed until resolved.

Question 6

a) - Ensures complaint reaches right person with right skills to solve it (e.g., billing complaint to finance).

- Avoids duplication and delay.

- Allows root cause analysis by relevant department to prevent recurrence.

- Creates accountability and ownership.

- Helps management see patterns of complaints in different departments.

b)- Escalate to immediate supervisor or manager.

- Refer to specialist department.

- Inform customer about escalation and give new contact person.

- Do NOT ignore or pretend to solve - be honest.

QUESTION 7

a) 1. Apology - sincere verbal or written apology.

2. Replacement of defective product.

3. Repair of product free of charge.

4. Refund or credit note.

5. Discount on next purchase or voucher.

6. Additional service free.

7. Correcting billing error.

b) 1. Telephone Call: direct personal contact - best for urgent complaints.

2. Email: written formal notification with reference number.

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3. SMS/WhatsApp: Quick update on progress.
4. Letter: Formal letter for serious complaints.
5. Face-to-face meeting: For major clients.
6. customer portal/CRM update: Customer can track status online.

Question 8

a) 1. Regularly review complaint data and identify trends.
2. Conduct customer satisfaction surveys.
3. Update complaints policy and train staff on new procedure.
4. Invest in better CRM system / technology.
5. Benchmark with other organizations best practices.
6. Get feedback from staff who handle ccomplaints

b) 1. Customer Retention: Angry customer becomes loyal if handled well.
2. Positive Word-of-Mouth: happy customer tells others.
3. Improved Reputation: Organization seen as caring.
4. Business Improvement: Complaints highlight weaknesses to fix.
5. Increased Sales/Profit: Retained customers buy more.
6. Competitive Advantage: Better service than competitors.
7. Staff Morale: Clear process reduces staff stress.
8. Legal Compliance: Avoids lawsuits and Consumer Commission complaints.
9. Prevents Social Media Damage: Stops negative posts on Facebook/TikTok.